(i) Table contains precise and accurate information, whereas graphs and diagrams give only an approximate idea.

(ii) More information can be presented in tables than in graphs and diagrams.

(iii) Tables require careful reading and are difficult to interpret, whereas diagrams and graphs are easily interpretable.

(iv) For common men, graphs and diagrams are attractive and more appealing than tables.

(v) Diagrams and graphs exhibit the inherent trends in the distribution easily on comparable mode than the tables.

(vi) Graphs and diagrams can be easily misinterpreted than tables.

Comparison between diagrams and graphs

(i) Diagrams can be drawn on plain papers, whereas graphs require graph papers.

(ii) Diagrams are appropriate and effective to present information about one or more variables. Normally, it is difficult to draw graphs for more than one variable in the same graph.

(iii) Graphs can be used for interpolation and/or extrapolation, but diagrams cannot be used for this purpose.

(iv) Median can be determined using graphs, but not using diagrams.

(v) Diagrams can be used for comparison of data/variables, whereas graphs can be used for determining the relationship between variables.

Points to Remember

- A diagram is a Visual aid for presenting statistical data.
- Simple bar diagram can be drawn either on horizontal or vertical base.It is used in Business and Economics.
- Pareto diagram is similar to simple bar diagram. Here the bars are arranged in the descending order of the heights of the bars. Also ,there will be a line representing the cumulative frequencies (in %) of the different categories of the variable.
- Multiple bar diagram is used for comparing two or more sets of statistical data.
- A component bar diagram is used for comparing two or more sets of statistical data, as like multiple bar diagram. But, unlike multiple bar diagram, the bars are stacked in component bar diagrams.